

altairsim — CP/M 2.2b on an Altair 8" floppy

2026-08-17 · 2b99dca

```
altairsim cpm22-buffered.toml
```

```
56K CP/M 2.2b v2.3  
For Altair 8" Floppy
```

```
A>DIR
```

Mike Douglas's track-buffered **CP/M 2.2b v2.3**, on an 8" Pertec FD-400 behind an 88-DCDD, booted by the DBL PROM at `FF00` — `RUN FF00` is the machine file's whole startup, because on a real disk Altair that was `EXAMINE FF00` and `RUN`.

`^E` (ATTN) takes the keyboard back to the monitor at any point; `RUN` resumes. `^C` belongs to CP/M (it is warm boot) and CP/M gets it.

The files

File	What it is
<code>cpm22-buffered.toml</code>	The machine: <code>base = "default"</code> plus the floppy in drive 0. Read it — it explains the memory arithmetic and what <code>readonly</code> really does on this controller.
<code>cpm22-terminal.toml</code>	The same machine and the same disk, but the console is a built-in VT100 window the simulator draws itself instead of <code>stdio</code> . The monitor stays in the terminal you launched from; CP/M comes up in its own window. No telnet client, no external emulator. Try <code>emulation=adm3a</code> for a period CP/M terminal.
<code>cpm22b23-56k.dsk</code>	The bootable system disk, built for a 56K machine. Carries <code>DDT.COM</code> , <code>M80 / L80</code> , <code>MBASIC</code> and the host-bridge utilities (<code>R</code> , <code>W</code> , <code>HDIR</code>), with 18K free. Shared by both machine files above.

There is no undo. Drive 0 is mounted read/write because that is what a real machine is, and CP/M writes to `A:` for anything you create. In a clone `git checkout` puts the image back; in the package you were handed, nothing does. Copy it first if you are about to test writes in anger.

Three drives are empty. `MOUNT dsk0:drive1 "my-scratch.dsk"` fills one, or `FORMAT` from inside CP/M will make you a disk.

`BOOT.ASM` and `BIOS.ASM` — this CP/M's own, and the authoritative source the 88-DCDD was built from — are in `disks/mits-88dcdd/cpm22/buffered/`. They are source rather than product, so they stay in the repository and are not in the package.